



Flow production

The purpose of flow (mass) production is to produce a large number of identical, standardized items. This usually happens on a moving line, which can be interrupted when the product is changed.

How it works

Flow production typically involves large factories equipped with conveyor belts and expensive machinery, the assembly of individual components, which may be bought in from other companies, and the automation of tasks. Car manufacturing is an

example where elements of the car are put together along a line; robot arms may install wheels and workers may perform specialized jobs. Significant output is possible with even a small number of workers. Newspaper printers, oil refineries, and chemical plants also use flow production.

The production line

In flow production, the item being made, such as a car, moves on a conveyor belt through different stages until completion. Components to build the car may have been outsourced or produced in another of the company's factories. They are all ready to be used along the line.

